



Put it on Paper

Nothing is still quite as impressive as reading off paper...

Rossi Fernandes and
Nimish Sawant
readersletter@thinkdigit.com

There's nothing quite like reading a letter on paper instead of on a bright screen. Even if you feel that's not the case, you'll always have so many things that you have to print – airline tickets, forms, letters, documentation, directions to a theatre, an invite for a concert...

It's a luxury that most people don't really need, but still want nonetheless. However, home users aren't the only ones who need to print. Every single office place needs a fast printer, something that 10 users or even 100 can print from. What's most important is that the printer

should be dependable and hassle-free. So, which is the best printer for you? For homes, for workplaces?

We received some 14 printers in all. Instructions were clear – everyday printers only! We'll have MFDs and photo printers for you in other months, because we feel that they are different enough to attract buyers for different reasons.

Entry-level inkjet printers for home

While testing printers in this category we were basically looking at affordable inkjet colour printers which could give out decent photo quality prints. This category is aimed at home users, who mostly print documents and web pages,

and the occasional photo. As we were looking at entry level printers, the ones that matched our requirements were the two Canon printers – the PIXMA iP1980 and PIXMA iP3680.

Canon PIXMA iP1980

For home users, who are looking for an affordable photo printer, the Canon PIXMA iP1980 comes as a boon. It's a very basic inkjet printer which is similar to the iP3680 in some ways.

The build quality is not that sturdy, as the plastic appears quite weak and has a tendency to bend in certain areas. The hinges are not steady either. The absence of a paper-out tray means you're going to have to play catch with printouts if this printer is at the edge of a table.

Setting up the printer is pretty easy though – with just two cartridges to be installed after powering it on. The software installation is also simple and quick, and the user interface is easy to navigate. There are settings to select paper options and also ink levels of the cartridges are shown.

There's a "quiet mode" option that allows you to print as quietly as possible, but at the cost of speed – useful if you're printing at night. The fast printing mode compromises a little too much on quality for us.

Canon PIXMA iP3680

This printer is targeted at photography enthusiasts. It looks good with its shiny glossy finish, and features an input and a rear tray to make managing paper easier.